Report a Wildfire Sighting

Report a suspected wildfire from safety. Give the call-taker the location and what you can actually see.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

For a fire emergency, call 911. Move away from immediate danger first. Do not approach smoke or flames, stop in a dangerous place, or delay evacuation to make observations.

MAKE THE REPORT

1. **Give the location.** Name the city, street address or nearest intersection, and landmarks. Distinguish where you are from where the smoke or fire appears to be. Say if the exact fire location is unknown.
2. **Describe what you see.** Report visible smoke or flames, nearby buildings or people at risk, and any injuries you know about. Separate observations from guesses.
3. **Give your callback number.** Answer the call-taker's questions and follow instructions. Stay on the line until told to hang up, unless remaining there puts you in danger.

A SHORT EXAMPLE

“I am in La Habra Heights at [your location]. I can see [smoke/flames] near [landmark or apparent location]. The exact location is [known/unknown]. My callback number is [number].”

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Do not wait for a neighborhood radio reply. A Fire Watch radio net, group message, website, or app is not a substitute for emergency dispatch. Do not call 911 merely to request incident updates.

After reporting: follow current official protective instructions. Use **COM-003** for alerts, **COM-004** for official information, and **EVS-003** for leaving promptly.

SOURCES

Sources checked 2026-11-13: City of La Habra Heights, Contact and Your Fire Department (911); National 911 Program, Calling 911 (updated 2023-01-24). Draft requires editorial and fire-service review.